Breaking Dance
The Art of Street Movement

Breaking dance, often called breakdancing or b-boying/b-girling, is a highly energetic and creative form of street dance that began in the early 1970s in the Bronx, New York City. It is one of the four main pillars of hip-hop culture, along with DJing, MCing (rapping), and graffiti art. Breaking was born in low-income neighborhoods, where young people turned to dance as a powerful way to express themselves, release energy, and build community.

At its core, breaking is a mix of dance, athleticism, and storytelling. It includes several key elements:

> **Toprock, which are upright dance steps that show rhythm and style.**
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> **Downrock, which involves footwork performed close to the ground.**
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> **Power moves, such as headspins, windmills, and flares, which require strength and agility.**
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> **Freezes, where the dancer stops in a dramatic, often physically demanding pose.**

Breaking is usually performed in battles, where dancers face off to music, showcasing their skills and creativity. These battles are about more than winning; they are about respect, originality, and passion. Dancers are known as b-boys and b-girls, and their goal is to express their identity and style through movement.

The music that drives breaking is typically based on breakbeats — rhythmic sections of funk, soul, or hip-hop songs that have a strong drumbeat. DJs used to loop these breakbeats to keep the energy high, which helped shape the dance itself.

What started on street corners and in community centers has now spread globally. Breaking is practiced in almost every country, and major international competitions are held each year. In fact, breaking was officially included in the 2024 Olympic Games in Paris, marking a major milestone in its history.

Breaking is more than just dance. It represents creativity born from struggle, unity in diversity, and the power of movement to tell a story without words.

Popping Dance
The Electric Art of Illusion and Control

Popping is a unique and eye-catching street dance style that focuses on quickly contracting and relaxing muscles to create a jerking effect, known as a "pop" or "hit," in the dancer's body. It originated in California during the 1970s, particularly within the African American and Latino communities, and became a major part of funk and hip-hop dance culture.

The dance is performed in rhythm with music—usually funk, electronic, or hip-hop beats—and is known for its robotic, wavy, or glitchy movements that give the illusion of mechanical or unnatural motion. Popping is often confused with locking or breaking, but it is a separate dance style that focuses more on isolation, control, and visual tricks.

Some of the most popular popping techniques include:

Waving – making the body appear to move like a wave.

Tutting – creating geometric shapes with the arms and hands.

Gliding and sliding – making the dancer appear to float across the floor.

Robot – moving in a stiff, robotic way.

Strobing – dancing in a stuttered, stop-motion style.

Popping is often performed in dance battles, where dancers challenge one another using free-style techniques to show off creativity, precision, and rhythm. The dance is not just about moves—it's about expression, style, and the ability to tell a story using illusion and body control.

One of the pioneers of popping is Boogaloo Sam, who founded the Electric Boogaloos, a dance crew that helped popularize popping across the world. Thanks to them and other early dancers, popping gained attention through television shows, music videos, and street performances.

Today, popping is practiced globally and remains one of the most respected and influential forms of street dance. It is a perfect example of how creativity, rhythm, and culture can come together to create something timeless and inspiring.

Locking Dance
Funky Moves Full of Energy and Expression

Locking is a fun, funky, and energetic style of street dance that originated in the late 1960s and early 1970s in Los Angeles, California. It was created by Don "Campbellock" Campbell, who developed the style by accident when he paused or "locked" during a dance move. That locking movement became the signature of the entire dance style, and from there, a new form of dance was born.

Locking is all about sharp, exaggerated movements, freezes (or locks), and playful expressions. It combines precise stops (locks) with lively, rhythmic steps. Dancers often use pointing, wrist twirls, hip rolls, and large, sweeping arm movements. Unlike more robotic street dance styles, locking has a light-hearted, comic, and interactive character. Dancers often engage with the audience through facial expressions, claps, or pointing, making it a highly entertaining style.

Some signature locking moves include:

The Lock – pausing suddenly in a strong position after a movement.

Wrist Rolls – rotating the wrists quickly in circular motions.

Funky Chicken – a goofy and energetic step that adds humor.

Pacing – quickly shifting steps side to side with attitude.

Scooby Doo – a bouncing step that mimics running in place.

Locking is most often danced to funk music, especially by artists like James Brown and The Meters. The rhythm and beat of funk tracks perfectly match the upbeat nature of locking. Don Campbell's dance crew, The Lockers, helped bring the style into the spotlight through TV appearances and stage shows.

Today, locking is still widely respected in hip-hop and funk dance scenes. It's performed in battles, shows, and even competitions worldwide. More than just a dance, locking is about joy, freedom, and connecting with others through movement and music. It shows that dancing can be fun, bold, and full of personality.

Krumping Dance
The Raw Power of Expression and Emotion

Krumping is an intense, expressive, and highly energetic style of street dance that originated in South Central Los Angeles in the early 2000s. It was created by dancers like Tight Eyez (Ceasare Willis) and Big Mijo (Jo'Artis Ratti) as a way to express emotions such as anger, pain, and joy through powerful movements, rather than through violence. Krumping is more than just a dance—it's a form of emotional release, freedom, and personal storytelling.

What makes krumping unique is its raw, freestyle nature and explosive energy. The dance features chest pops, arm swings, stomps, jabs, and intense facial expressions. Movements are fast, sharp, and exaggerated, often resembling a controlled chaos. But behind that chaos is rhythm, skill, and meaning.

Krumping is performed in sessions (gatherings of dancers) or battles, where dancers take turns freestyling to express their feelings and challenge each other. These battles are not about hate—they're about respect, growth, and releasing emotions in a powerful but peaceful way.

Some core elements of krumping include:

- **Stomps – strong, rhythmic foot hits to the ground.**
- **Chest pops – powerful outward motions of the chest.**
- **Jabs – fast, aggressive punches in the air.**
- **Arm swings – large and exaggerated swinging of the arms.**
- **Facials – expressive facial emotions that match the movement.**

Krumping was made widely known through documentaries like Rize (2005), directed by David LaChapelle, which showed how dance gave hope and strength to young people in tough neighborhoods. The film helped krumping gain global attention and respect.

Today, krumping is practiced by dancers around the world and is featured in competitions, workshops, and performances. It continues to evolve while staying true to its roots: using dance to heal, connect, and speak without words. Krumping proves that dance is not just movement—it's a powerful language of the soul.

House Dance
Freedom and Flow on the Dance Floor

House dance is a fast-paced and soulful street dance style that originated in the underground clubs of Chicago and New York City during the 1980s. It developed alongside house music, which is a style of electronic dance music with deep basslines and steady 4/4 beats. House dance is known for its fluid footwork, grooves, and freedom of movement, making it one of the most expressive and musical forms of dance.

Unlike other street styles that focus on sharp or isolated moves, house dance emphasizes continuous movement, rhythmic flow, and improvisation. Dancers often move with the beat, layering their steps with smooth transitions, body rolls, and quick footwork patterns. The energy is both relaxed and intense, giving dancers space to feel the music and connect with the vibe of the crowd.

Key elements of house dance include:

Footwork – fast, intricate steps that flow with the beat.

Jacking – a grooving motion of the torso that creates bounce and rhythm.

Lofting – fluid floorwork with smooth transitions and slides.

Skating and stomping – light, gliding movements combined with strong accents.

One of the most important aspects of house dance is freedom. It encourages creativity, individuality, and personal expression. It's common to see dancers freestyling (improvising) in cyphers—circles formed in clubs or battles—where people take turns showcasing their moves.

House dance was influenced by many styles, including tap, African dance, salsa, capoeira, and jazz, making it a rich blend of cultures and histories. Over time, it has grown from underground clubs to international stages, workshops, and dance festivals.

Today, house dance continues to inspire dancers worldwide with its soulful connection to music and emphasis on personal style. It's not just about technique—it's about feeling the music, letting go, and moving with heart and rhythm.

Litefeet Dance
The Bounce and Swagger of New York

Litefeet is a high-energy street dance style that originated in Harlem and the Bronx in New York City during the early 2000s. Known for its bouncy steps, athletic tricks, and playful swagger, Litefeet was created and popularized by young dancers who brought their talent to subway trains, streets, and schools. The term “Litefeet” comes from the idea of having “light feet” — moving quickly and smoothly while staying in rhythm.

Litefeet is often called the “new generation of hip-hop dance” and is known for its quick foot-work, head tosses, hat tricks, and shoe tricks. One of the most famous Litefeet moves is the "Tone Wop," which involves a rocking groove with the upper body, usually combined with quick foot movement. Another popular move is the "Rev Up," a fast-paced step that gives the dancer the appearance of building up energy.

Key characteristics of Litefeet dance include:

Bouncy movement and a consistent groove.

Fast footwork with turns, hops, and spins.

Creative tricks using hats, shoes, or shirts.

Freestyle battles in subway stations, parties, and dance circles.

Litefeet is deeply connected to youth culture, urban expression, and music. It’s usually danced to Litefeet tracks — a sub-style of hip-hop music with upbeat, repetitive beats perfect for fast-paced movement. Dancers like Chrybaby Cozie, Bonez, and groups like Team Litefeet helped the style grow in New York and beyond through social media, YouTube, and street performances.

Though Litefeet started informally, it has become a respected dance style around the world. Many dancers now teach and perform Litefeet internationally, sharing its roots in creativity, fun, and resistance.

Litefeet is more than a dance—it’s a movement. It represents youth power, urban culture, and the idea that anyone, anywhere, can express themselves through rhythm, movement, and joy.

New School Dance Style
The Evolution of Street Dance

New School dance style refers to a range of modern urban dance forms that emerged mainly in the late 1990s and 2000s, influenced by the rise of hip-hop music, pop culture, and social media. Unlike the more traditional or “Old School” styles like breaking, popping, and locking, New School dances are more fluid, open, and constantly evolving. They are usually inspired by the latest trends, music videos, and viral internet culture.

One of the main features of New School dance is its connection to hip-hop choreography and commercial dance. These styles are often seen in music videos, dance battles, stage performances, and social platforms like TikTok and Instagram. New School choreography is typically faster, more polished, and more diverse in movement, often blending elements from jazz, contemporary, krumping, popping, house, and even African and Latin dances.

Key characteristics of New School dance include:

- Sharp and clean movements combined with body grooves.
- Emphasis on musicality, rhythm changes, and hitting beats.
- Group choreography and formations.
- Freestyle elements, allowing dancers to add personal flair.
- Influence from fashion, attitude, and pop culture.

Popular New School styles and moves include:

- Hip-Hop choreography – fast-paced routines often seen in dance studios.
- Jerkin’, Dougie, Nae Nae, and other viral dances from the 2000s and 2010s.
- Urban dance – a fusion of hip-hop and studio styles used in performances.

Today, New School dance is one of the most practiced and performed dance styles globally. It is taught in dance studios, featured in major competitions like World of Dance, and shared widely online by influencers and choreographers. Thanks to platforms like YouTube and TikTok, New School continues to evolve rapidly, allowing dancers of all backgrounds to share their creativity with the world.

New School dance represents the modern spirit of street dance—creative, diverse, inclusive, and always changing with the times.